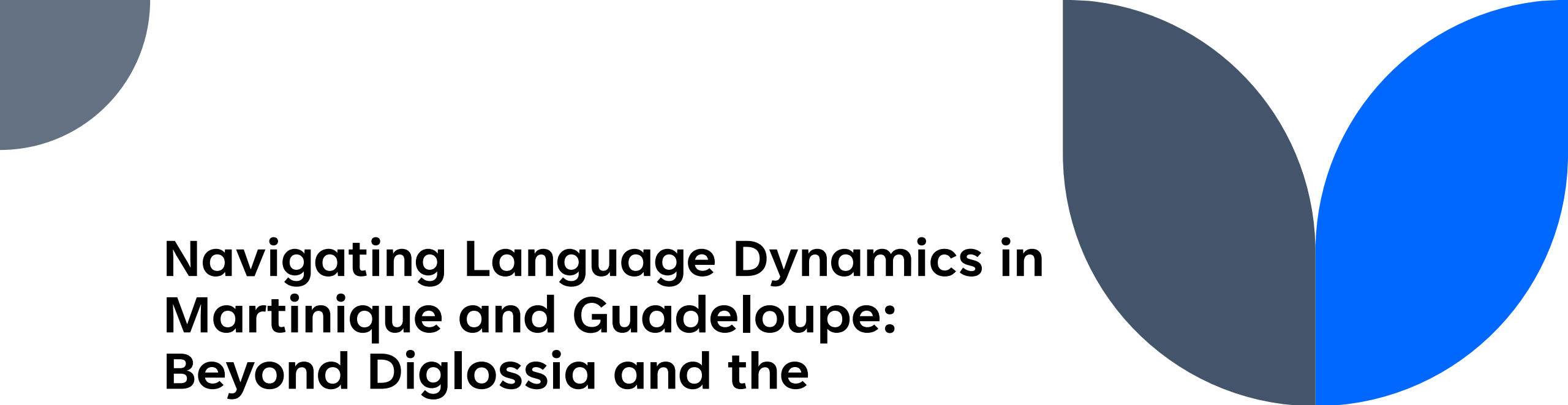
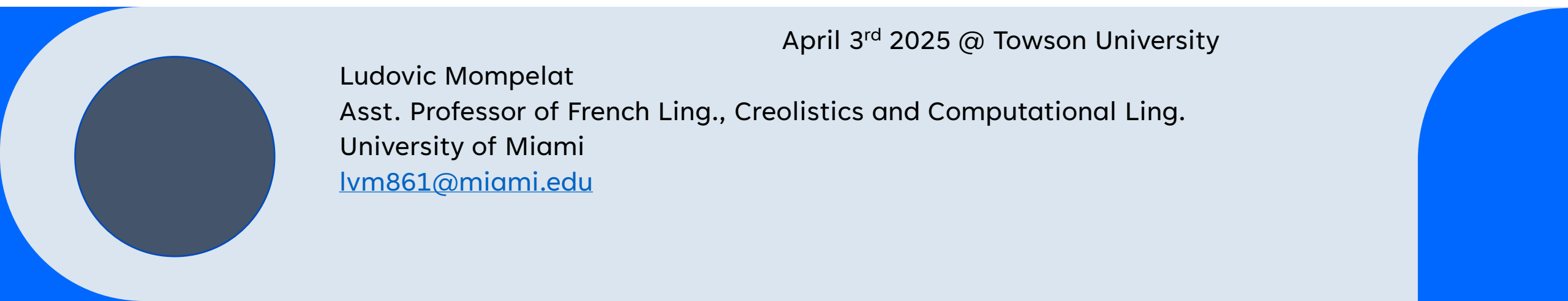




Navigating Language Dynamics in Martinique and Guadeloupe: Beyond Diglossia and the Continuum

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Ludovic Mompelat
Asst. Professor of French Ling., Creolistics and Computational Ling.
University of Miami
lvm861@miami.edu

Linguistic situation in Martinique and Haiti

- French-based Creoles with substrate influence from Manding, West Atlantic, Gbe languages (Yoruba and Igbo), Bantu and Kwa languages
- Today : Martinique is home to 368k inhabitants – 90% of the population with Creole as their native language vs. 95% with French as a second native language or learned at school
- Today : Haiti has about 9.5 million speakers and 3 million worldwide with a minority of the population speaking French (about 7%)



Diglossia

Extends the works of Prudent (1981), Bernabé (1983) and Managan (2016) and their (re)-definition of the linguistic situation in Martinique and Guadeloupe.

- Consensus that Ferguson's (1959) definition of diglossia cannot alone account for the observed sociolinguistic situation.
 - Diglossia originally described the **duality of codes for a single language** between a « literary » and « scholastic » written variety, and a more « vulgar » and usually spoken variety
 - Diglossia is described as a specific kind of idealized bilingualism in a society where one of the languages has high prestige/status and the other has low prestige/status.
- Later the definition expanded **to the duality of two distinct languages in contact** (Fishman 1967)

On Martinique's and Guadeloupe's diglossia

In early accounts of diglossia in Martinique and Guadeloupe, the Creole language would be the more « vulgar » and « spoken » variety therefore less prestigious, and French the more « literary » and « scholastic » written variety viewed as more prestigious.

However, more recently, we note a breakdown of the strict functional distribution of the H and L varieties between French and MC, where they both spread virtually through all H and L contexts. (Managan 2016)



Prudent's & Bernabé's approaches

Prudent 1981

We must get rid of the notion of diglossia altogether because it is an outdated ideologically charged notion and it does not represent the current linguistic situation anymore
There is no more a Martinican Creole pole at one end, and French pole at the other end of the linguistic continuum

Rather there is a common macro-language which is both and neither representing *“a unique grammar capable of producing utterances considered to be French as well as utterance considered to be creole”* (1993: 24-26).

There is an interlectal zone defined as *“a dynamic discursive space where numerous code-switching, code-mixings, and interferences occur”* along with utterances that cannot be described by any of the grammars in contact (hypercorrections or hypercreolizations)

Bernabé 1983

There is a need to keep the conceptual extreme poles (basilectal Creole and Acrolectal French) separate while engaging with a similar interlectal zone he call the mesolectal continuum.
An interlectal zone free of any reference to the two extreme poles is not sustainable because the cases of hypercorrections and hypercreolizations can be traced back to one of the poles as main contributor.

There are « two continua [French and Creole] articulated around a discontinuous zone. » resulting in an intermediate zone in which both lects, French and Creole, are in constant contact and where abstract phonological, lexical, morphosyntactic,

There is a mesolectal zone where linguistic exchange occurs but where reference is attributable to one or the other poles. This means that all semantic, prosodic, and pragmatic items are organized according to a specific grammar.

Managan's contribution

- Within basilectal Creole she identifies :
 - *Gwo kréyòl* the old spoken variety of older generation and monolingual creole speakers
 - *Kréyòl grangrèk* the standardized, codified and written form of basilectal Creole
 - They are in a diglossic relationship à la Ferguson
- Found perception of linguistic domination of French over Creole from Guadeloupeans → Justify the need for Diglossia
- Found that in reality the functional distinctions between French and Creole are breaking down

Proposal

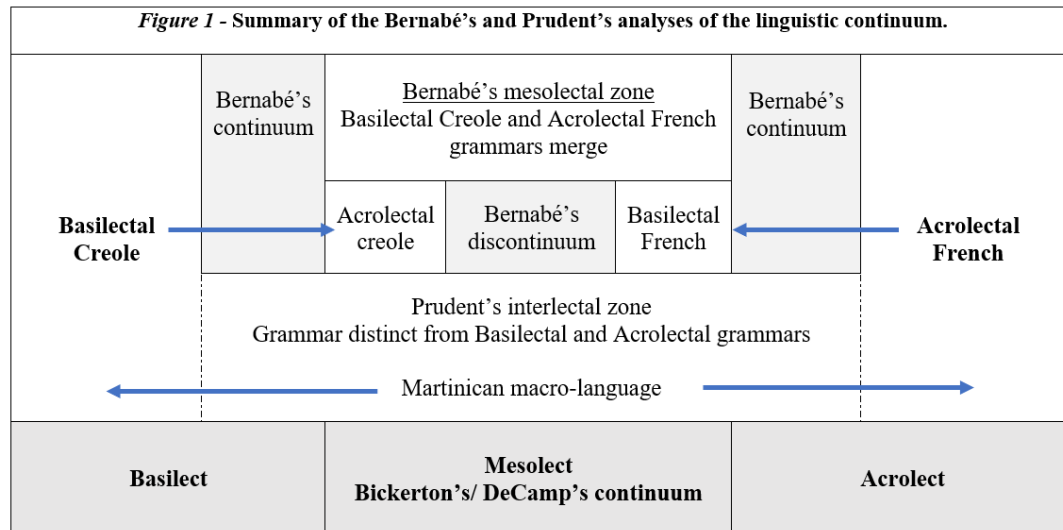
Reassessing these concepts, I propose the following:

- **Perceived Diglossia** : « *The language attitudes and subjective evaluations held by speakers regarding language varieties or lects within a community. It encompasses the social prestige, acceptability, desirability, and symbolic value speakers attribute to each variety.* »
- **Functional Diglossia** : « *Functional diglossia refers to the objective, observable distribution of language varieties across distinct domains or contexts of language use within a community. It encompasses how languages or varieties are actually utilized in specific functional contexts, such as education, government, media, or informal everyday settings.* »

These definitions serve to reconcile Managan's observations regarding:

- 1) the diglossic distinction that Guadeloupeans make between French and Creole and
- 2) the fact that both language varieties are found in virtually all functions of society seemingly contradicting the previous statement

From a 1-dimensional schema...



A single axis of language varieties from the most basilectal to most acrolectal fails to depict the break down of the effective diglossic relationship between French and Creole, and only represents and maybe reinforces the longwithstanding and often wrongfully adopted view of the perceived diglossia that places French as the prestige variety and Creole and the less prestigious reality



...to a 2-dimensional schema

Standard Language/High Prestige [++formal]	Kréyòl Grangrèk Formal Written Creole [++prestige]	Mesolectal/interlectal Zone		Standard French Formal Written French [++prestige]
	Gwo Kréyòl [-formal, +prestige]	Mesolectal Creole [-/+formal, -prestige]	Mesolectal French [-/+formal, +prestige]	Spoken Metropolitan French [+formal, +prestige]
H Functions / [+formal]				
				
L Functions/Non-standard [-formal]				
	Basilect	Basi-Mesolect	Acro-Mesolect	Acrolect

Figure 1 - Description of Martinique's and Guadeloupe's Linguistic Continua

On X-axis – The Creole continuum: The linguistic continuum from one language to another where intermediate lects are represented

On Y-axis – The Diglossic continuum : The linguistic continuum within a single lect from least formal (L functions) to most formal (H functions)

On X and Y-axes – The varieties in contact: Represented as the orange boxes are placed in relation to the continuum, their function, and also their associated prestige which determines the height within a given square
Offers new avenues for a possible formalism

Perceived diglossia comparing different varieties

Proposed account

We want to keep both Ferguson's and Fishman's definition of Diglossia, along with the notion of linguistic continuum.

- Ferguson (1959) (diglossia within a single lect) accounts for recent development in Creole standardization giving way to a H/prestige Creole variety and a L/low-prestige variety.
 - French Diglossia : Standard French – Colloquial French – Mesolectal French
 - Creole Diglossia : Standardized Creole (Kréyòl granrèk) – Gwo kréyòl – Mesolectal Creole
- Fishman's (1967) (Diglossia across language varieties) follows Bernabé's position on the existence of two distinct poles while still compatible with Prudent's interlectal zone
- The linguistic continuum Basilectal to Acrolectal to represent the languages in contact

Martinique and Guadeloupe's linguistic continua

Standard Language/High Prestige [++formal] H Functions / [+formal] L Functions/Non-standard [-formal]	Kréyòl Grangrèk Formal Written Creole [++prestige]	Mesolectal/interlectal Zone		Standard French Formal Written French [++prestige]
				Spoken Metropolitan French [+formal, +prestige]
	Gwo Kréyòl [-formal, +prestige]	Mesolectal Creole [-/+formal, -prestige]		Mesolectal French [-/+formal, +prestige]
	Basilect	Basi-Mesolect	Acro-Mesolect	Acrolect

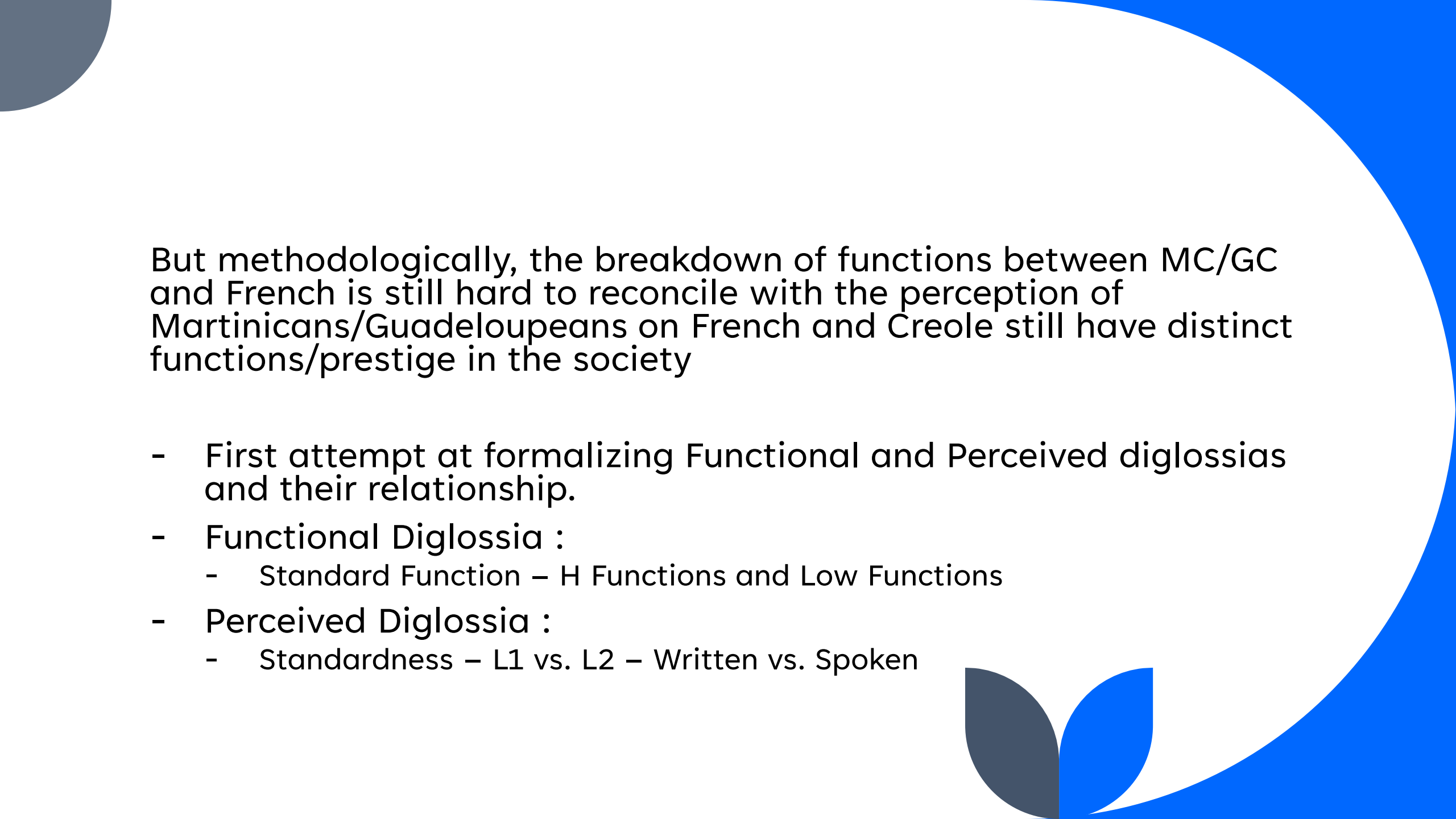
Figure 1 - Description of Martinique's and Guadeloupe's Linguistic Continua

Tentative description to Haiti's continuum

Standard Language/High Prestige [++formal] H Functions / [+formal] ↕ L Functions/Non-standard [-formal]	Standard Written Creole	Mesolectal/interlectal Zone		Standard French Formal Written French [++prestige]
		Kreyòl Swa [+/-formal, +prestige]	Mesolectal French [+formal, +prestige]	Standard S. French [+formal, ++prestige]
	Kreyòl Rèk [+/-formal, -prestige]			
	Basilect	Basi-Mesolect	Acro-Mesolect	Acrolect

Figure 2 - Tentative Description of Haiti's Linguistic Continua

How to formalize this?



But methodologically, the breakdown of functions between MC/GC and French is still hard to reconcile with the perception of Martinicans/Guadeloupeans on French and Creole still have distinct functions/prestige in the society

- First attempt at formalizing Functional and Perceived diglossias and their relationship.
- Functional Diglossia :
 - Standard Function – H Functions and Low Functions
- Perceived Diglossia :
 - Standardness – L1 vs. L2 – Written vs. Spoken

Calculating the functional diglossia score

Identify specific functional contexts and give them score points:

Standard Domains ([++formal]): government documents, official websites, formal literature, education. (3 points written / 2 points spoken)

H Functions ([+formal]): Written & spoken formal contexts (schools, media, public speaking). (3 points written / 2 points spoken)

L Functions ([-formal]): Written & Spoken informal contexts (daily conversation, casual media, digital communication). (2 points written / 1 point spoken)

Calculating the functional diglossia score

Functional Diglossia (linked to the language use for each linguistic variety) measures the contexts in which each linguistic variety is found.

Proposed methodology : For each language variety, we measure its frequency or dominance (yes/no, or categorical) within each context via Corpus analysis and/or sociolinguistic surveys

Variety	Dominant Contexts	FD Score	Ranking
Standard Written French	Standard (W:3), H-Functions (W:3)	$3 + 3 = 6$	1
Standard Written Creole	Standard (W:3), H-Functions (W:3)	$3 + 3 = 6$	1
Creolized French	H-functions (S:2), L-Functions (W:2, S:1)	$2 + 2 + 1 = 5$	2
Frenchified Creole	H-Functions (S:2), L-Functions (W:2, S:1)	$2 + 2 + 1 = 5$	2
Spoken M. French	H-Functions (S:2)	2	3
Gwo Kréyòl	L-Functions (S:1)	1	4

Reflect the interlectal zone, reconcile Prudent's and Bernabé's account of the sociolinguistic situation in Martinique, with mesolectal forms and language mixing being more prominent in the overall context of communication.



Calculating the Perceived diglossia score

Perceived Diglossia (linked to the prestige attributed to each linguistic variety) measures speakers' attitudes toward each linguistic variety

Proposed methodology : Done via a sociolinguistic survey that determines the importance of Standardness, Written modality, and French vs. Creole among speakers. – Varieties are then ranked from no perceived prestige (0) to highest perceived prestige (4)

Variety	Weighted Perceived diglossia +S=2, +W=1, +Fr=1	PD Score	Ranking
Standard Written French	+S, +W, +Fr	$2 + 1 + 1 = 4$	1
Standard Written Creole	+S, +W, -Fr	$2 + 1 + 0 = 3$	2
Mesolectal French	-S, +Fr	1	4
Mesolectal Creole	-S, -Fr	0	5
Spoken M. French	+S, -W, +Fr	$2 + 0 + 1 = 3$	2
Gwo Kréyòl	+S, -W, -Fr	$2 + 0 + 0 = 2$	3

The standardness is more salient in Martinique as the Standard creole variety is regarded as more prestigious than the other varieties of Creole



Calculating the Total diglossia score

The total diglossia score is the weighted sum of the Perceived Diglossia and Functional Diglossia.

Proposed methodology: Give Perceived diglossia score more weight compared to Functional diglossia

Variety	PD Score x2	FD Score	TD Score	Ranking
Standard Written French	8	6	14	1
Standard Written Creole	6	6	12	2
Mesolectal French	2	5	7	4
Mesolectal Creole	0	5	5	5
Spoken M. French	6	2	8	3
Gwo Kréyòl	4	1	5	5

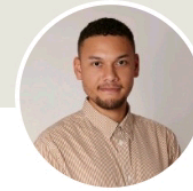
The weight given to PD is representative of the difference in the perceived functions of each variety (The Speakers assumptions on the functions of each varieties and the actually attested functions)
The bigger the difference the less likely the community is aware that the diglossic situation is breaking down, the smaller the difference the more aware they are of the actual functions of each variety

Discussion

- Offers a formalism for future sociolinguistic analyses :
 - Common framework of comparison across territories with clear weighted scores that are context-dependent
 - It formalizes research on diglossia and bilingualism and allow for refinements of the definitions (i.e. impact of standardness, Written forms, one lect vs. Another lect)
 - Combines speaker perceptions and language attitudes with empirical evidence of language use
 - The total diglossia score offers a more robust representation of the ranking of language varieties in contact within a given situation
- For future work :
 - Design pilot sociolinguistic surveys purposefully designed to inform us on how to :
 - Better determine and refine the weighting component of Functional diglossia and its +S, +W and +Fr features
 - Better determine the weighting component of Total Diglossia score and the justification for a distinct weighting for Perceived diglossia with regards to Functional diglossia

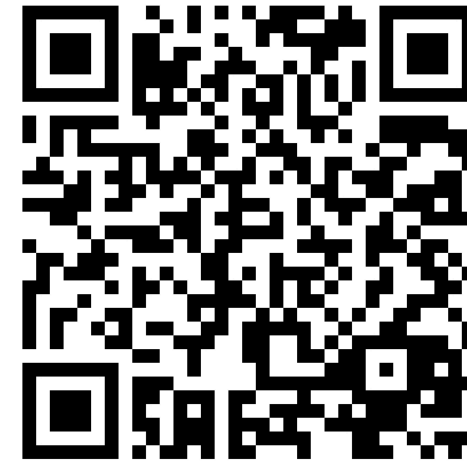
Thank you

Email: lv861@miami.edu



Ludovic Mompelat

Assistant Professor - French, Creole and
Computational Linguistics, PhD

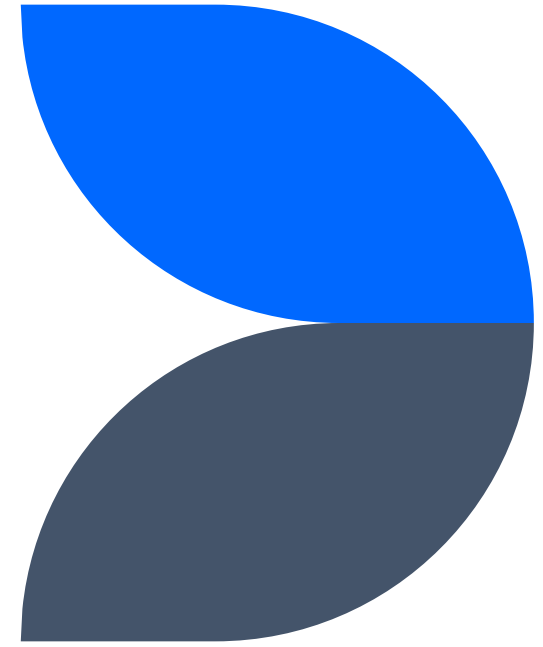


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Explanation



Functional Diglossia for Haiti vs Martinique

Variety	Haiti	Martinique	Ranking H:M
Standard Written French	Standard (W:3), H-Functions (W:3) = 6	Standard (W:3), H-Functions (W:3) = 6	1:1
Standard Written Creole	Standard (W:3), H-Functions (W:3) = 6	Standard (W:3), H-Functions (W:3) = 6	1:1
Meso. French	H-functions (S:2), L-Functions (W:2) = 4	H-functions (S:2), L-Functions (W:2, S:1) = 5	3:2
Meso. Creole	H-Functions (S:2), L-Functions (W:2, S:1) = 5	H-Functions (S:2), L-Functions (W:2, S:1) = 5	2:2
Spoken S. French	H-Functions (S:2) = 2	H-Functions (S:2) = 2	4:3
Basi. Creole	H-Functions (S:2), L-Functions (W:2, S:1) = 5	L-Functions (S:1) = 1	2:4

Standard varieties are N°1.

H = Mesolectal Creole and Basilectal Creole are next
Monolingual population in Creole

Then Mesolectal Creole then Spoken S French

Standard varieties are N°1.

M = Mesolectal forms are next (bilinguals)

then Spoken S French more an ideal/rarer in isolation / and gwo kreyol The ancestors language

Perceived diglossia for Haiti vs Martinique

Variety	HC +S=1, +W=1, +Fr=2, +M=2	MC +S=2, +W=1, +Fr=1	Ranking H:M
Standard Written French	+S, +W, +Fr = 4	+S, +W, +Fr = 4	1:1
Standard Written Creole	+S, +W, -Fr = 2	+S, +W, -Fr = 3	3:2
Meso. French	-S, +Fr, +M = 3	-S, +Fr = 1	2:4
Meso. Creole	-S, -Fr, +M = 2	-S, -Fr = 0	3:5
Spoken M. French	+S, -W, +Fr = 3	+S, -W, +Fr = 3	2:2
Basi. Creole	+S, -W, -Fr = 1	+S, -W, -Fr = 2	4:3

The standardness is more salient in Martinique as the Standard creole variety is regarded as more prestigious than the other varieties of Creole /

In Haiti the Standard variety is based on a regional variety of HC spoken by monolinguals and not an idealized version

The French vs. Creole feature appears more salient in Haiti than in Martinique because French is overwhelmingly perceived as more prestigious than Creole

Haiti possesses a +M for (mesolectal) feature because the presence of French features to a language variety is perceived as more prestigious / Whereas in Martinique the presence of French features in Creole is perceived as less prestigious

Calculating the Total diglossia score

Variety	HC Diglossia Score	MC Diglossia Score
Standard Written French	14	14
Standard Written Creole	10	12
Mesolectal French	10	7
Mesolectal Creole	9	5
Standard S. French	8	9
Basilectal Kréyòl	7	7

HC Ranking	MC Ranking
1. Standard Written French	
2. Standard Written Creole	2. Standard Written Creole
2. Mesolectal French	3. Standard S. French
3. Mesolectal Creole	4. Mesolectal French
4. Standard S. French	4. Basilectal Kréyòl
5. Basilectal Kreyòl	5. Mesolectal Creole